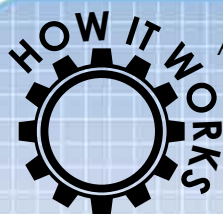


General Electric first made and sold this affordable steel fridge in 1927, finally making the refrigerator a common household appliance.

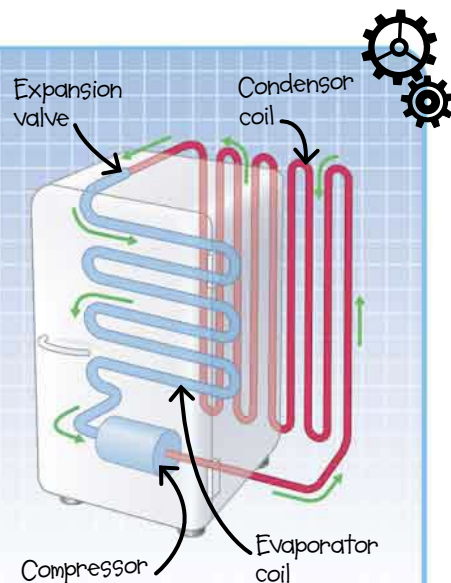


Fatal fridges

Until 1929, refrigerators were deadly—they used **poisonous gases** as coolants and were responsible for several deaths. As a result, a safer **CHLOROFLUOROCARBON (CFC)** called freon was used to cool refrigerators. It was not harmful to human health, but later scientists realized that CFCs were destroying the Earth's ozone layer. Modern fridges use *a less harmful coolant* to reduce the environmental impact. They can also be recycled safely.



A refrigerator works by changing a substance called a coolant from a liquid to a gas and back again. The liquid passes through an expansion valve, which turns it into a cold gas. The gas absorbs heat from the refrigerator's contents, keeping them cool. The gas is compressed into a liquid as it leaves the refrigerator, which heats it up. The liquid loses heat to the room before passing through the expansion valve again.



Did you know?

German physicist Albert Einstein invented a refrigerator in partnership with his former student Leo Szilard and patented it in 1930.

How it changed

Chilling food keeps food fresh and safe for longer periods of time. This has changed customer shopping habits—people no longer have to go shopping every day, saving time and effort.

the world

American Clarence Birdseye invented a method of **FLASH FREEZING** food in 1929. Not long afterward, **DOMESTIC FREEZERS** became popular.



The first large-scale **AIR-CONDITIONING UNIT** was invented in 1902 by American inventor **WILLIS HAVILAND CARRIER**. It used the same principle as the refrigerator.